

WEEK 3 LESSON OUTLINE

**STICK
TOGETHER**

BIG IDEA

Good friends are worth fighting for.

BIBLE

Proverbs 27:17; Acts 15:36–41;
Psalm 51:10

ABOUT THIS WEEK

Strong friendships form through journeys that face storms and disagreements, but they're worth holding onto. This week, we'll see how Paul and Barnabas's conflict led them down different paths, yet later repair showed the value of sticking together... reminding us **good friends are worth fighting for.**

WHAT?

We've been talking about the kinds of friends we want to "stick with," in both good times and bad. You know, really good friends. "Good" friends of course exist, but no friendship is perfect. Not even the ones in the movies.

But some friendships (the really good ones) are too valuable to throw away when things get tough. If we do, we sometimes miss out on the kind of deep, strong, worthwhile friendships you only get by sticking it out. Friendships can get complicated, tense, and difficult. So when do you know when to walk away and when to keep going?

SO WHAT?

Proverbs 27:17 says, "iron sharpens iron"—the right friendships help us grow. There's friction in sharpening, but in godly friendships, disagreement can make you better if you fight for each other, not just against.

In Acts 15:36–41, Paul and Barnabas disagreed and went separate ways. But in 2 Timothy 4:11, they reconciled and decided their friendship and God's mission were worth fighting for.

Conflict and difficulty can make you wiser if you let God lead you. When friendship gets hard, don't give up. Ask if God is helping you grow through it. Because **good friends are worth fighting for.**

NOW WHAT?

So next time you find yourself in some friction with a friend...

- **PAUSE.** Don't panic! No friendship is without conflict. In fact, sometimes it's needed.
- **REFLECT.** Have you tried their perspective? What can you learn? Is something underneath the argument?
- **ASK.** Ask God how to grow. Ask a wise person to help.
- **TRY.** One small step—a chat, text, or kind word—can help. Don't quit too soon.

When you have a friend you know is worth it, make sure you stick together. Because **good friends are worth fighting for.**